

Questions You Can Ask When Choosing a Lender

Here are some questions you can ask when choosing a lender to decide if they are the right fit for you and your homebuying goals.

Loan Options + Fit

- ☐ Do you personally regularly work with first-time homebuyers?
- ☐ Which down payment assistance (DPA) programs do you work with? If yes, which ones?
- ☐ Do you offer any direct down payment or closing cost assistance

Interest Rates + Costs

- ☐ How do you decide what interest rate I will qualify for?
- ☐ Are your loans' interest rates fixed or adjustable? *(For first-time homebuyers, a fixed-rate mortgage the safest and most reliable type of loan)*
- ☐ What fees should I expect?
- ☐ Can you provide a Loan Estimate so I can compare costs with other lenders?

Pre-Approval Process

- ☐ What documents do you need to issue a pre-approval?
- ☐ How long does the pre-approval process usually take?
- ☐ How long is my pre-approval valid?
- ☐ What could cause my pre-approval to change or be withdrawn?

Timeline + Communication

- ☐ How long does it typically take to close a loan once I have a signed contract?
- ☐ How will you communicate with me during the process (email, phone, online portal)?
- ☐ Who will be my main point of contact?

Next Steps

- ☐ What steps should I take now to strengthen my loan application?